

Ole Kirk Kristiansen

The BRICK that changed the world

The LEGO® Group began with Ole Kirk Kristiansen's belief that "only the best is good enough." In time, a little plastic brick would take the world by storm.



Starting blocks

Kristiansen was born in the village of Filskov, Denmark, in 1891. When he finished school, he became a *carpenter* and started his own business. He built houses, and made stepladders and ironing boards, but **he also made toys**, including trains, cars, and ducks. In 1934, he named the company LEGO, deriving from two Danish words *leg godt*, or **PLAY WELL**.

By the way...

in 1949, I launched "Automatic Binding Bricks," but it wasn't until 1958 that my son, Godtfred Kirk Kristiansen, invented the LEGO brick as we know it today.

He couldn't have done it without...

The **FIRST BUILDING BLOCK SET** was made of wood by the brilliant German educator **FRIEDRICH FROEBEL** (1782–1882) in 1840.

American toymakers **JESSE** (1858–1920) and **CHARLES CRANDALL** (1833–1905) made the first **INTERLOCKING** blocks in the 1860s.